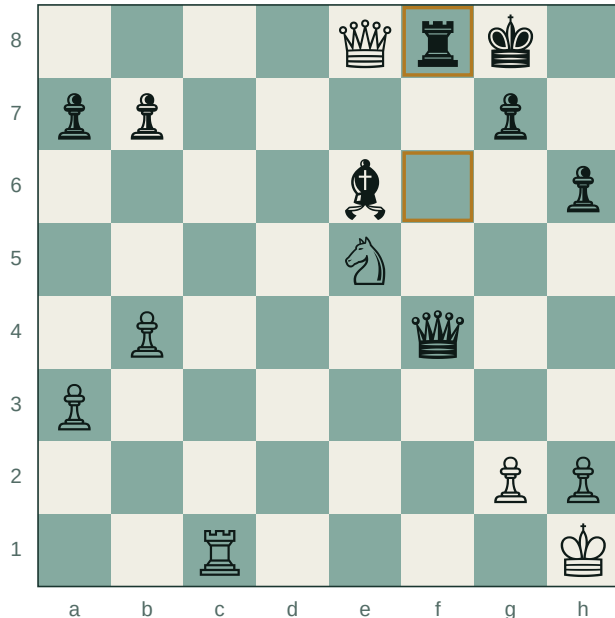


Active defensive resources: White, move 30

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 29...Rf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Qxe6+ Kh7 31. Rg1

30.Qxe6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **30...Kh7**.

31.Rg1 The rook moves from c1 to g1.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: rook on f8.